of Bhup Singh and leaning against the door started firing at the enemy closing in on the bunker. An enemy LMG burst fired into the doorway killed my adjutant, Captain Bhatia, and broke the top of my left shoulder. I had the pleasure of killing the Chinese who shot my adjutant. Finally an enemy bullet hit my left elbow and broke it. Due to the loss of blood, I fell down with my left leg outside the bunker. A Chinese fired a burst into it and broke my leg below the knee. Lieutenant Bhup Singh pulled me in and covered me with a blanket.

'The Chinese were now closing in on the bunker from all sides. Bhup Singh manned the doorway and single-handedly kept the Chinese at bay. By this time all firing outside had ceased. This was the last bunker holding out. The enemy kept firing the machine gun into one side of the bunker while still engaging the doorway. Finally, on the third side of the bunker, they crawled up and blew the side in with a pole charge (exploding explosives fastened to the end of a pole)'. Rikh was in a semi-conscious state, fast losing blood. Bhup Singh was still fighting, manning the doorway. Finally his ammunition ran out. The Chinese, seeing that all the firing from within the bunker had ceased, rushed into it and overpowered Bhup Singh, who was pointing to Rikh and screaming, 'commanding officer… commanding officer'. The Chinese got the message, and did not bayonet the wounded Rikh. After a while, they took Rikh outside and put him on a stretcher. His wounds were then bandaged by a Chinese nursing orderly.

Further downstream, Alpha Company's position at Bridge 3 as well as the Assam Rifles post above had got a heavy, prolonged dose of mortar fire. The Chinese would only get to them after having dealt with Battalion HQ and the defences at Bridge 4. With no danger of accidently hitting their own troops, the Chinese bombardment was more spread out here. Jemadar Ghanshyam Singh, commanding No. 3 Platoon, the easternmost Rajput position, was killed during the early stages of the bombardment and Subedar Phool Singh, the senior company JCO, replaced him.

During the hour-long shelling, the Assam Rifles men slowly melted away, leaving the post completely vacant. When the Chinese arrived from the west, they initially assaulted this position, but finding it abandoned, they turned the full fury of the attack on CHM Saudagar Singh's No. 2 Platoon that got assaulted from above and the western flank. Subedar Basdeo Singh's No. 1 Platoon, sited overlooking Bridge 3, was also soon embroiled in fierce hand-to-hand fighting. Some survivors of No. 2 Platoon would